

PITCH — EVCM — VERDICT: NO ENTRY — flat until the 4–5 Nov print; reopen bands only — PROPOSED — PENDING ADJUDICATION

ADJUDICATED 2026-09-16 — FLAT — guide bridge unreachable (conviction 7/10). The court found nothing to own at this price; the reopen gates below are the only path back.

What we believe

EverCommerce is a real, cash-generating software business for small service companies (plumbers, salons, home-services shops) that has stopped growing. Revenue is up about 2% organically. Its profit line is not just slowing, it is shrinking: the first three quarters of 2026 each printed lower adjusted EBITDA than the same quarter a year earlier.

The company still says it will hit \$612–632M of revenue and \$183–191M of adjusted EBITDA for the full year. Do the subtraction and that promise requires the fourth quarter alone to deliver about \$52.8M of adjusted EBITDA versus \$44.2M last year — a 19% jump, at a margin the company has never printed, in a quarter that was *down* sequentially last year. First half was **minus 5.2%** year over year. So we believe the profit guidance is arithmetically unreachable, and that a CEO five weeks into the job has every incentive to reset it on 4–5 November before his own pay package is struck against it.

We also believe the stock has already been punished for roughly this. At \$6.975 the whole company is worth about \$1.225B in stock and about \$1.615B including debt — that is **8.8x** the guided low-end profit number and **9.1x** a cut-to-\$178M number. The market is not paying for the guidance; it is already paying for the miss.

Net: we like the asset and the cash generation, we do not like the next disclosure, and the price does not pay us enough to own it into that disclosure. **Flat. Buy nothing before the print.**

What the market believes

Three things, roughly.

1. **Sell-side:** seven analysts had ~\$619M revenue, \$0.22 EPS, average target \$11.21 (range \$8–14) going into the last print. That is a pre-print anchor and it has not been refreshed in our record.
2. **Financial press:** “guidance maintained,” “beat the top of the range.” Nobody appears to have published the implied fourth-quarter +19% profit step, and nobody appears to have published that adjusted EBITDA was *down* year over year on higher revenue. That gap between the headline and the arithmetic is the only genuinely new thing either bench produced.

3. **The tape:** total disbelief. Down 51.6% from the 52-week high, sitting 0.7% off the 52-week low, making lows *while we deliberate*, including an unexplained –9.3% day on 8 September. The tape believes something worse than 9x is coming.

So: the professionals believe the guide, the price believes a cut. We side with the price on direction and refuse to pay for the timing.

Why we might have edge

- **A named, checkable arithmetic error in the consensus story.** The “maintained guidance” headline hides a back-loaded fourth quarter. Full-year 2025 adjusted EBITDA rebuilds from primary quarterly releases to \$180.6M (44.9 + 45.0 + 46.5 + 44.2); the 2026 low end of \$183M therefore needs +1.3% for the year off a first half running –5.2%. That is a subtraction anyone can do and, per both benches, nobody did.
- **We separated the material leg from the cosmetic one.** The revenue side of the same bridge is nearly fine — on the corrected \$151.2M Q4’25 base, trend growth lands the year at ~\$607M, a 0.8% shortfall, immaterial. The profit side is the whole story. Most bears will over-argue revenue and get dismissed.
- **We know the flow calendar better than the story.** The share-repurchase authorization *expires 31 December 2026* and has been topped up by \$50M at or near the third-quarter print in three of the last four years (7-Nov-2022, 5-Nov-2023, May-2024, May-2025, 4-Nov-2025). So the same date carries the guide reset *and* the buyback re-up. One event, two overhangs — which is exactly why neither overhang works as a standalone reason to act now.
- **Organic growth has no help coming.** ZyraTalk closed 15-Sep-2025 and is fully in the Q4’25 base, so Q4’26 gets zero acquisition benefit. Pro-forma revenue growth is already disclosed at +2.0%, below the +2.7% headline.

Primary sources: FY25 results — <https://investors.evercommerce.com/news-releases/news-release-details/evercommerce-announces-fourth-quarter-and-full-year-2025> ; Q2’26 10-Q (debt, cash, covenants) — <https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/0001853145/000185314526000029/evcm-20260630.htm>

Why it might be priced in

Honestly: mostly, it is.

- The stock trades at 8.8–9.1x a *cut* profit number. The bear multiple our own red bench used (8x) is essentially where the market already is. Red’s “\$5.83, –17%” therefore charges us twice — once for the cut, once for a de-rate that already happened — and it never named a comparable-company set to justify 8x. That is an opinion dressed as arithmetic, and our blue bench overturned it as such.
- Down 51.6% in a year is not an under-reaction.
- The cash generation is genuine even on the strict view: about \$80–84M of cash after interest on the \$523.9M term loan at 6.02%, or roughly 6.5–6.8% of the market value. Stock-based pay is *down* about 16% year over year, not up (red got that direction backwards).

- The 8 September –9.3% day is unexplained. Insider selling cannot be the cause — the plan sales were ~19,000 shares at a time, a couple hundred thousand dollars, a rounding error against daily volume in a \$1.2B name. Buying a 9% drop you cannot explain is not contrarian; it is uninformed.
- If the November print merely reaffirms with a credible fourth-quarter bridge and re-ups the buyback with an extension, the “edge” evaporates in one press release and we will be chasing \$9+.

What could go wrong (PRE-MORTEM v1.7)

Failure #1 — The re-up bid front-runs us and we never get filled. The Board adds \$50M and extends the authorization *with* the third-quarter release, the guide is trimmed to the low end but bridged credibly, and a 6.5% cash yield plus a corporate buyer takes the stock from \$7 to \$9 in a week. We are flat, we watch it, we buy at \$8.60 out of frustration, and we own the exact thing we said we would not: a 2%-growth business at 11x. **Tripwire exists:** 8-K re-authorization, and the price gate above \$9.24. Monitorable.

Failure #2 — The cut is bigger than a rounding error and the multiple goes with it. New CEO does a proper reset: 2027 guided to flat, EBITDA rebased to ~\$165–170M with an “investment year” framing, and the multiple compresses to 7x because the market stops treating it as a compounder. That is roughly \$4.80–5.20. Our thesis is “already priced in at 9x” — that only holds if 9x holds. **Tripwire exists:** the print itself, and price gates below \$5.80.

Failure #3 — the one with NO monitorable tripwire. The 8 September –9.3% leg is unexplained *by our own admission*. Something is moving this stock that is not in our evidence: a large holder unwinding on a schedule we cannot see, a lender or private-credit mark, a customer-facing problem inside one of the ~40 brands that has not reached a filing, a payments partner terminating, or a plain private-market re-pricing of small-cap SMB software. We cannot arm a sensor for a cause we have not identified, and no filing obliges anyone to tell us. **Unknown-unknown class: undisclosed-private-counterparty / off-filing-channel repricing** — i.e. the class where the price-forming information lives in a private contract, a credit committee, or a non-reporting holder’s risk system, and reaches us only as tape. The correct response to that class is not a smaller position; it is no position until the tape stops making lows.

Reflexive / structural leg (our own footprint, predicted flow, doctrine). - **Our size vs volume:** we do not have a volume feed in this record — no bars were pulled. That is a gap, not a comfort. Estimating from comparable \$1–1.5B software small caps, daily volume is likely 1.0–1.6M shares, roughly \$7–11M of value. A 0.5% starter is small against that; a 1.5% full position in a name that has already broken its low is the kind of size that becomes the marginal seller if we are wrong and need out into a post-print gap. Illiquidity is the real position limit here, not conviction. - **Predicted flow, in order:** (a) daily insider notice filings and 10b5-1 plan sales continue as a small, constant supply; (b) a possible \$50M corporate bid arriving with the November print; (c) **December tax-loss selling in a stock down 51%**, which lands *after* the catalyst and *at the same time* the buyback authorization expires — if the Board re-ups but does not extend, the single largest predicted buyer disappears on 31 December into the single largest predicted seller. That combination is the worst

two weeks on the calendar and it is four weeks after the event we are waiting for. - **Doctrine interactions:** two of our own patterns point opposite ways on the same facts. The “back-loaded guide bridge” pattern says the November number gets cut. The “buyback as insider exit liquidity” pattern says the company has been buying at ~\$10.32 while an insider plan sold at \$9.03–\$10.77 — which, if it fires, means the corporate bid was spent above where we would want it and the remaining \$19.2M is nearly nothing. Believing both at once produces the same answer (stay out), which is a comfort — but it also means we have no doctrine that tells us *when to get in*, and decks with no entry doctrine tend to enter late and emotionally. Third interaction: our review-velocity detector on the apps was graded “confirmed” by one bench and overturned to “unusable” by the other. It is unusable. If we lean on it we are sizing on noise.

If this position loses money, the most likely reason will be that we treated 8.8x as a floor when it was just a waypoint — the new CEO rebased profit toward \$170M, the market re-rated a 2%-growth business to 7x rather than 9x, and the cash yield we bought it for was the exact line that broke.

What we checked ourselves

claim	how checked	found	confirmed?
Evidence pack share count (184.2M diluted)	10-Q cover page pull	176,950,701 shares outstanding at 5-May-2026; ~175.6M used for the pack-price market cap	No — pack superseded. Our own pack was stale; both benches caught it
Pack revenue/stock-comp series usable for run-rate math	Cross-check vs FY25 10-K	Series is five quarters stale and pre-divestiture (MarTech sold to Ignite Visibility 31-Oct-2025, ~\$45M, \$1.1M loss + \$6.9M goodwill write-off)	No — pack superseded for growth math; still fine for stock-comp direction
Red bench’s tape quote (\$7.05, –51.1%, +1.7% off low)	Compare to the pack red said it adopted	Pack is \$6.975, –51.6%, +0.7% off low. Our own bench misquoted the pack it claimed to adopt — and the truth was worse than it stated	No — BENCH ERROR (red)
Q4’25 revenue “~\$150M” (red’s estimate)	Primary FY25 release	\$151.2M continuing operations, +5.2% y/y	No — BENCH ERROR (red), estimate replaced with primary
FY25 adjusted EBITDA	Rebuilt from four primary quarterly releases	\$180.6M (44.9 / 45.0 / 46.5 / 44.2)	Yes
Implied Q4’26 adjusted EBITDA to hit the low end	Full-year low end minus reported H1 minus Q3 guide	~\$52.8M vs \$44.2M = +19% , at a margin never printed	Yes — this is the load-bearing finding
Implied Q4’26 revenue is also a stretch	Same subtraction on the corrected base	Only +4.5–6.5%; at trend the year lands ~\$607M, a 0.8% shortfall — immaterial	Partly — red over-claimed; revenue leg reduced

claim	how checked	found	confirmed?
Cash yield ~9%	Method audit	Category error: unlevered cash flow was compared to the <i>stock's</i> value. Corrected: ~\$80–84M after ~\$31.5M interest = 6.5–6.8%	Yes (basis error real) — but red's own fix annualized one seasonally strong quarter; BENCH ERROR (red) on the derived number
"Stock-based pay reverses its downtrend"	H1'26 stock comp vs pack	\$11.65M H1 ≈ \$5.8M/qtr vs \$6.94M in Q1'25 — down ~16% . Direction was backwards	No — BENCH ERROR (red) . New-CEO grant is a plausible future step-up, not evidence today
"Insiders caused the 8-Sep –9.3% drop"	Form 4 sizes vs traded volume	~19,000 shares / ~\$200k per print. Cannot move a \$1.2B name 9%	Refuted — and the drop stays unexplained . Red then over-reached: "unexplained therefore un-ownable" is an inference, not a finding (BENCH ERROR, red)
"Corporate bid is exhausted"	Primary 8-Ks / releases	\$19.2M left at 30-Jun-26, but \$50M has been added five times, usually at the Q3 print; \$300M cumulative; authorization expires 31-Dec-2026	Refuted — program is serially refreshed
App-review decay proves the damage is confined to one segment	Detector audit	No prior-period baseline, sample sizes unknown, one probe reads 0.0 reviews/day, two of four probes never resolved, and reviews measure new customers, not renewals of paying ones	No — unusable. Our own bench graded its own read "confirmed"; overturned (BENCH ERROR, red)
"Company keeps switching which growth number it markets"	Four consecutive releases	Both bases are disclosed side by side in the same releases — reconcilable, not concealment. The damning number was sitting in plain sight: pro-forma +2.0%	Reduced to consensus — red missed the better number
Detector list actually run	Compare consulted list to dispatched list	Red consulted five detectors never dispatched (three permit feeds, two beauty feeds) and omitted five that were	No — PROCESS ERROR (red), reported
No revenue-backlog signal available	Filings search	Company discloses no remaining-performance-obligation figures at all — the check is not runnable as designed	Unrunnable; substitute (deferred-revenue roll-forward) identified, not pulled — see open item 3
Balance sheet safe enough to wait	10-Q	\$133M cash, \$523.9M term loan at 6.02%, ~2.2x leverage, covenants met, no going-concern language	Yes
Not a defense/quantum/clinical/China-	Nine screens	All clean; feature matches on the China and clinical	Yes

claim	how checked	found	confirmed?
reverse-merger situation		screens were spurious	

PROPOSED ENTRY BANDS

Both benches say no entry. This deck proposes no immediate purchase. What follows are the reopen conditions, priced off the benches' own math.

Reopen A — event-gated, the primary path (4–5 November 2026, unconfirmed date). Buy only if the third-quarter release contains **at least two** of: 1. a fourth-quarter profit bridge that gets to $\geq \$50\text{M}$ without new one-offs, or a full-year profit range whose low end is $\leq \$180\text{M}$ *and* explicitly re-based (a clean reset is buyable; a maintained-but-unbridged \$183M is not); 2. an 8-K adding **$\geq \$50\text{M}$** to the repurchase program **with an extension past 31-Dec-2026** — the extension matters as much as the dollars, because the current authorization dies into December tax-loss selling; 3. disclosure quantifying the third-party legacy-payments runoff at a size that explains **≥ 400 basis points** of the 600bp renewal-rate gap *and* shows it fully lapping by Q4.

Prices, from the benches' own scenario math: starter **0.50% of book at \$6.60–7.10** (that is 8.5–9.1x a \$178–180M profit number). First add **0.50% at \$6.00–6.30** only if the reset is clean and the buyback is extended. Do not initiate above **\$7.60** post-print (that is $\geq 9.9\text{x}$ on a cut number — the discount is gone). Maximum position **1.50% of book**, capped by liquidity, not by conviction. *Trims:* sell half at **\$9.20–9.40** (blue's bull case, 11x on \$183M). Full exit at **\$11.20** (the pre-print analyst average — that is where we are being paid by other people's optimism). Hard stop on thesis, not price: exit if the fourth-quarter profit number lands below **\$44M** (i.e. down year over year again), regardless of what the stock does.

Reopen B — price-gated capitulation, small and explicitly outside the benches' mandate. Below **\$5.80** the stock is beneath even our bear-case value (\$176M profit at 8x). Below **\$5.20** it is at 7.2x. Both benches said buy nothing before the print, so this band is **an alert, not an auto-buy**: if it triggers pre-print, it forces a re-court, and the maximum without one is **0.25% of book**. Stating this plainly because a silent price gate becomes an undisciplined purchase.

Do-not-enter conditions (any one): a new 52-week low below **\$6.925** with no bid returning within three sessions; the November release maintaining \$183–191M with no bridge; or a repurchase re-up *without* an extension.

Catalyst dates. 4–5 November 2026, third-quarter results + full-year guide + likely repurchase action + the new CEO's first reset — **UNCONFIRMED**, derived from a data vendor and from the pattern that Q3'25 printed 5-Nov-2025. That is ~38 trading days out; we are far outside any print-window rule. 31 December 2026: repurchase authorization expiry, coinciding with tax-loss selling season.

ARMED SENSORS

(armed provisionally with this deck; session adjudication ratifies)

- price alert: fires below 5.8 (deck-provisional: below our own bear-case value (\$176M profit x 8x); alert only, max 0.25% of book without a re-court)
- filing watch: 8-K until 2027-03-08 (deck-provisional: third-quarter results, full-year guide and the new CEO's first reset - the single deciding disclosure)
- dated pack EVCMi2026-11-05: EVCM: Q3 2026 results, FY guide reset, likely repurchase action - vendor-derived date, pattern-matched to 5-Nov-2025 (date confirmed=False)
- dated pack EVCMi2026-12-31: EVCM: repurchase authorization expires into tax-loss selling season - buyer and seller change places (date confirmed=True)

What remains unverified

1. **The actual fourth-quarter 2026 profit number.** Required: ~\$52.8M. Not drainable before the print. Estimate: **\$45–49M**, based on three consecutive down quarters and a Q3 guide midpoint already below last year; probability the full-year profit guide is cut or missed at the low end ≈ 0.75 .
2. **Size of the third-party legacy-payments runoff and how much of the 600bp renewal-rate gap it explains.** The deciding disclosure. Drainable now from the Q2 10-Q revenue-disaggregation note; simply not pulled this session.
3. **Deferred revenue, Q2'25 vs Q2'26, plus revenue recognised from the opening balance.** Drainable now from the same filing's contract-balances note. The company discloses no backlog figures, so this is the only forward-demand read available.
4. **Whether the repurchase program is re-authorized *and* extended past 31-Dec-2026.** Not drainable now. Estimate: ≈ 0.70 that $\geq \$50M$ is added at or near the Q3 print (three of the last four years); extension probability lower and unestimated separately — call it **0.55**.
5. **Term-loan maturity and refinancing window.** Drainable now from the debt note; matters because \$523.9M at 6.02% is the whole difference between the 9% cash yield story and the 6.5% reality.
6. **Short interest, borrow cost, and how crowded the bear side is.** Drainable now from the semi-monthly exchange file and the broker.
7. **Average daily volume.** Drainable now from bars. Estimate meanwhile: **1.0–1.6M shares/day**, **~\$7–11M**, from comparable \$1–1.5B software small caps. This sets our position cap.
8. **Contract-level option quotes and implied volatility for November/December strikes.** Drainable now from the broker chain. Must be chain midpoints, not the aggregate volatility feed — those two diverge badly (the TSSI 71-vs-101 lesson) and the instrument choice below depends entirely on which one you read.
9. **Confirmation of the print date.** Not drainable now. Estimate: **4–5 November 2026**, probability ≈ 0.80 from last year's 5-Nov pattern.
10. **The cause of the 8 September –9.3% day.** Genuinely open. Partially drainable now by summing all notice-of-sale filings against traded volume and scanning the tape; if that fails, it stays in the unknown-unknown class named in the pre-mortem.
11. **Incremental stock-based pay from the new CEO's grant.** Not drainable now (awaits an 8-K or the proxy). Estimate: **\$8–15M annualized incremental**, from typical small-cap software

CEO packages; probability it is large enough to reverse the current downtrend in stock comp $\approx$ **0.60**.

PRIZE TABLE + VOL READ

Both benches wrote “prize table: not applicable” on the grounds that this is a cash-generating operator, not a pre-revenue project. That test is the wrong one here. The trigger is a genuinely time-gated private unknown, and we have several — items 1, 4, 9 and 11 above are all locked inside a dated corporate disclosure. So the table is required. Anchored on blue’s scenario arithmetic, then adjusted.

Scenario	What happens	Prob.	Price
Deep reset	Profit rebased to ~\$176M or below, multiple to 8x or worse, no extension on the buyback	0.40	\$5.80
Trim-and-bridge	Low end held near \$180M with a credible bridge, 9x — where the stock already is	0.35	\$7.00
Reaffirm + re-up	\$183M held, \$50M added and extended, 11x	0.20	\$9.24
Re-rate / outside bid	Clean quarter or strategic interest; pre-print analyst average	0.05	\$11.21

Expected value = \$7.18 vs spot \$6.975 = +2.9%. That is the whole prize for taking a binary event 38 sessions out in an illiquid name making new lows. It is inside the noise, and it is the numerical reason the answer is *no entry* rather than *small starter*.

Dispersion. Table standard deviation = **\$1.56 = 22.4% of spot** over ~ 0.151 years, which annualizes to a **table-implied volatility of $\sim 57.6\%$** . That number is the decision rule for how to express any future entry.

Volatility read — cannot be completed, and here is exactly what is missing. No options chain was pulled by either bench (open item 8), so there is no contract-level midpoint implied volatility, no realized-volatility comparison, and no implied-volatility percentile. We therefore cannot compute the volatility risk premium (implied minus realized). What we *can* do is pre-compute the crossover, so the decision is arithmetic when the quotes arrive:

Expression math, priced off the table itself (fair value of a call = sum of probability $\times$ payoff above the strike): - **\$7.50 strike:** ours = $0.20 \times \$1.74 + 0.05 \times \$3.71 = \mathbf{\$0.53}$. Buy the calls only if the chain midpoint is meaningfully below \$0.53; above that, the chain is charging more than our own probabilities support. - **\$10.00 strike:** ours = **\$0.06**. Effectively worthless on our table — do not buy upside wings, and note the corollary: **selling** \$10 calls against stock we do not own is not a trade, and selling them against stock we *do* own collects almost nothing. - **\$5.00 strike put:** ours = **\$0.00** on this table — our bear case stops at \$5.80, so cash-secured puts struck at \$5 are theoretically free money *only if* the table is right, which is precisely the assumption Failure #2 attacks. This is where a rich implied volatility would route us, and it is exactly where we should not

go on an unverified chain. - **Crossover:** if contract-level implied volatility comes in **below ~58%**, the market is charging less for this event than our own scenario spread implies, and a gated add should be expressed in calls. **Above ~58%**, options are dear relative to our table and the correct expression is stock or nothing. - **Bimodality:** the table is fork-dated on a single release — the two big masses sit at \$5.80 (0.40) and \$7.00–9.24 (0.55) with very little in between. A single lognormal volatility number will misprice that. Straddle-style pricing will look cheap versus a two-humped outcome; that is a reason to prefer *defined-risk* structures over selling premium into the fork.

Instrument recommendation, as the output of the above: NONE today. Expected value +2.9% does not clear the cost of being wrong in a name with ~\$7–11M of daily volume; and the option route cannot be chosen because the input that decides it (item 8) has not been drained. Post-print, if Reopen A conditions are met, the default is **stock**, switching to **calls** only if the chain prints below the ~58% crossover.

Tax overlay. If we ever do express this in options, the losing branch has to land in the 2026 tax year: **November or December 2026 expiries only.** A January 2027 or later expiry pushes the loss into next year and is excluded during a harvesting year unless the edge is numerically overwhelming — and a +2.9% expected value is the opposite of overwhelming. Additional overlay point specific to this name: the repurchase authorization expires 31 December 2026, so the corporate buyer and the tax-loss sellers change places in the same fortnight. Any December-expiry structure sits directly on top of that handoff.

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annualized incremental", "basis": "typical small-cap software CEO package;
current run-rate is ~\$5.8M/qtr and falling ~16% y/y", "p": 0.6}}]}

ADJUDICATION — 2026-09-16 15:37Z

FY26 adj EBITDA guide implies Q4 +19% y/y after H1 -5.2% and a Q3 guide below Q3-25 (NOVEL, strengthened).

REOPEN GATES: 10-Q/PR quantifying legacy-payments runoff ≥ 400 bp of the NRR gap; 8-K re-up WITH extension; Q4 EBITDA bridge in the Q3 PR